

# Facilitator Notes

Total Time: approx. 75 minutes

## Spark – 10 minutes

- **Step 1: Personal Poll**  
Ask learners to reflect privately on how often they say yes when they don't want to. Use the multiple-choice options to guide self-awareness.
- **Step 2: Reflection Prompt**  
Learners consider why they say yes even when it's not the best choice. Invite them to choose from a list of common reasons. Optional: Have learners share in chat or small groups.
- **Step 3: Cross-Cultural Discussion (Optional)**  
Invite learners to consider how their cultural background, family norms, or community influence their instinct to say yes or no. Highlight how these patterns can impact professional communication and stress levels.

## Shift – 35 minutes

- **Podcast Input (5–7 minutes)**  
Play the podcast *From Yes to Stress: A Lesson in Boundary Language*.  
After listening, invite learners to reflect:
  - What emotions or pressures influenced the character's yes?
  - What would you have done in their place?
- **Boundary Phrase Matching Activity (10 minutes)**  
In groups or individually, match real workplace scenarios with appropriate boundary phrases and tones.  
Debrief:
  - Why does the chosen phrase fit?
  - Would you adjust it for your workplace?
  - How might tone shift depending on the person or platform?

- **Tone & Cultural Awareness (5 minutes)**

Discuss tone: direct vs. softened responses, and when each is most effective.

Optional extension: Have learners rewrite each phrase to suit different audiences (peer vs. manager, chat vs. email).

- **Guided Practice (10–15 minutes)**

Learners review three workplace scenarios (worksheet or slide). For each, they:

- Use the 4 self-check questions.
- Decide whether a yes or no is appropriate.
- Choose or write a boundary phrase.
- Practise saying it aloud.  
Debrief in small groups or full class:
- What tone felt right?
- What was challenging?
- How would you adapt this in your real-life work setting?

- **Cultural Case Study: Rina's Story (Optional or Integrated)**

Explore how cultural expectations shape communication using Rina's scenario.

Prompt discussion or reflection:

- Why did Rina say yes?
- What would a respectful boundary phrase look like in this situation?
- How would you respond in her place?

## **Stretch – 20 minutes**

- **Application Task (Self-guided or Homework)**

Learners apply the boundary language this week:

- Practise saying no respectfully.
- Try saying yes with clear limits.

- Reflect on how each felt and how it was received.
- **Journal Prompts:**
  - How did your yes responses change when guided by your priorities?
  - What changed when you said no clearly?
  - How can you build on this skill in future conversations?

## **Reflect & Close – 10 minutes**

- Invite learners to choose one boundary phrase from today that they want to keep using.
- Ask: When and where will you try this phrase?
- Optional: Share in chat or say aloud.
- Recap the core takeaway: Saying no clearly and kindly builds trust, reduces burnout, and protects your time.
- Thank participants and preview what's next (if part of a series).